MOORE, RUSSELL AND EARLY WITTGENSTEIN

SYLLABUS ITEM 6, PAPER I SECTION A — Defence of Commonsense · Refutation of Idealism · Logical Atomism · Logical Constructions · Incomplete Symbols · Picture Theory of Meaning · Sying and Showing

REVOLT → ATTRIBUTION → CHRONOLOGY → THREE ANALYSES → MOORE: TRUISMS · LEVELS · CERTAINTY · PROOF · OBJECTION → MOORE: ACT/OBJECT · THE TWO SENTENCES · BOUNDARY → RUSSELL: SYMBOLS · DESCRIPTIONS · PUZZLES · SCOPE · ACQUAINTANCE · NAMES · CONSTRUCTIONS · ATOMISM · TRUTH-FUNCTIONS · SUPPORT-NOT-PROOF → TRACTATUS: ONTOLOGY · PICTURE · SENSE · GENERAL FORM · SAY/SHOW → COMPARISON AND CRAFT

Read the cyan rail from stage 01 to stage 28. Stages 01–28 are the complete core spine; the single grey stage E is optional enrichment and is never needed for a core answer. Every stage uses a layout chosen for its own content — chains, ladders, matrices, timelines, comparisons, stacks and trees.

01

THE ANALYTIC REVOLT — ONE TARGET, THREE PROGRAMMES

BRITISH ABSOLUTE IDEALISM = THE TARGET · **BRADLEY · McTAGGART** · **INTERNAL RELATIONS · DEGREES OF TRUTH** · **ORDINARY WORLD DEMOTED TO 'APPEARANCE'**

NO SYSTEM MAY OVERRULE WHAT WE ORDINARILY KNOW OR SAY

MOORE 1873–1958 — DEFENDS
Weapon: compare the CERTAINTIES
'Your premiss is less certain than my hand'
Result: knowledge is protected; analysis left open

RUSSELL 1872–1970 — DISSECTS
Weapon: rewrite in QUANTIFIED logical form
'Your "the F" was never a name — watch it vanish'
Result: ontology slimmed; inventory left open

EARLY WITTGENSTEIN 1889–1951 — PICTURES
Weapon: fix the CONDITIONS OF SENSE
'Your sentence never pictured anything'
Result: the boundary of sense drawn; the book's own status left open

SHARED INSIGHT **GRAMMATICAL FORM ≠ LOGICAL FORM**, and the shared unit is the **proposition**, not the system. Influence runs both ways: Moore's act/object distinction is taken over by Russell for sense-data, and Russell's 1918 preface credits logical atomism to Wittgenstein.

ANSWER LINE The three programmes agree that philosophy proceeds by **analysis** and disagree about **what analysis reaches**.

02

THE ATTRIBUTION FIREWALL — SEVEN PRINTED TERMS, THREE OWNERS

PRINTED SYLLABUS TERM	OWNER	KEY TEXT
Defence of Commonsense	MOORE	'A Defence of Common Sense', 1925
Refutation of Idealism	MOORE	'The Refutation of Idealism', *Mind*, 1903
Logical Atomism	RUSSELL **and distinctly** WITTGENSTEIN	'The Philosophy of Logical Atomism', 1918 · *Tractatus*
Logical Constructions	RUSSELL	'The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics'; *Our Knowledge of the External World*, 1914
Incomplete Symbols	RUSSELL	'On Denoting', 1905; *Principia Mathematica*
Picture Theory of Meaning	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN	German 1921; bilingual *Tractatus* 1922
Saying and Showing (printed 'Sying')	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN	4.12–4.1212 · 6.522 · 6.54 · 7

OWNED HERE
Moore: truisms · knowing vs analysing · comparative certainty · hands proof + three conditions · act/object · transparency
Russell: incomplete symbols · descriptions · three puzzles · scope · acquaintance and the Principle · constructions · atomic facts · truth-functions · negative facts
Early Wittgenstein: facts not things · objects and states of affairs · picture theory · pictorial vs logical form · bipolarity · logical space · general form · *sinnlos* vs *unsinnig* · saying/showing · ladder · 7
All fourteen routed 2018–2025 parts

vs

NOT OWNED — CROSS-OWNED OR OPTIONAL
Verification principle, rejection of metaphysics → **TOPIC 07**
Meaning as use, language-games, family resemblance, private language → **TOPIC 08**
Strawson's positive semantics and persons → **TOPIC 11**
Berkeley's immaterialism → **TOPIC 03** · Hegel's Absolute Idealism → **TOPIC 05**
Naturalistic fallacy and Open Question Argument → MOORE'S ETHICS, *Principia Ethica* 1903 — not this clause
Russell's logicism, paradox, theory of types, later neutral monism → optional orientation only

FIREWALL This is the only Western clause in which **attribution is itself examinable**. 'Moore and Russell held that…' without a discriminating clause has already lost a mark. Mnemonic: **Moore DEFENDS, Russell DISSECTS, Wittgenstein PICTURES.**

03

CHRONOLOGY RAIL — THE MINIMUM THAT PREVENTS ANACHRONISM

1893 **Bradley**, *Appearance and Reality* — the target in place
1903 **Moore**, 'The Refutation of Idealism' (*Mind*) — and *Principia Ethica*, same year, **ethics**
1905 **Russell**, 'On Denoting' (*Mind*) — descriptions begin
1912 *Problems of Philosophy* Ch. 5 — the **Principle of Acquaintance**
1914 *Our Knowledge of the External World* — the **supreme maxim**
1918 **Russell's lectures** (preface credits Wittgenstein) + *Tractatus* manuscript
1921 **German** text: *Logisch-Philosophische Abhandlung*
1922 **Bilingual** edition; Latin title suggested by **Moore**; Ogden translation
1925 'A Defence of Common Sense' — the **truisms** paper
1929 'Some Remarks on Logical Form' — **colour exclusion**
1939 'Proof of an External World' — the **hands** paper
1950 **Strawson**, 'On Referring' — presupposition
1956 **Sellars** — the Myth of the Given
1961 **Pears–McGuinness** translation
1970/80 **Kripke**, *Naming and Necessity* — lectures 1970, book 1980

THREE CHEAP MARKS The **1903 / 1925 / 1939** separation in any Moore answer · Russell's own **1918 attribution to Wittgenstein** in any atomism answer · the **1921 German / 1922 bilingual** split in any *Tractatus* answer. Never date the English text 1921; never merge Kripke's two dates.

04

THREE SENSES OF 'ANALYSIS' — THE DISTINCTION MOST SCRIPTS MISS

PROGRAMME	INPUT	OUTPUT	SUCCEEDS WHEN
MOORE	an ordinary judgement already **known**	an account of what that judgement commits us to	the commitments are clear — and if they are not, the **knowledge is untouched**
RUSSELL	a sentence whose surface suggests a suspect entity	a **quantified paraphrase** in which the apparent name disappears	truth-conditions are preserved and the ontological commitment removed
EARLY WITTGENSTEIN	any proposition whatever	resolution into **truth-functions of elementary propositions**	a base of logically independent elementary propositions is reached — a base the text **never exhibits**

EXAMINABLE CONSEQUENCE Because 'analysis' means three different things, the three men can share a slogan and still disagree about everything that matters. **Russell's descriptions do not vindicate Moore's truisms; Moore never accepted that ordinary objects are constructions; Wittgenstein's objects are not Russell's sense-data.**

05

MOORE 1925 — THE LIST OF TRUISMS AND THE SECOND-ORDER CLAIM

THE LIST. 'There exists at present a living human body, which is my body' · 'This body has existed continuously on or near the earth' · 'The earth has existed for many years past' · 'There have existed many other human beings, with bodies'

FIRST-ORDER CLAIM. Moore does not merely assert that these are true: he asserts that he **KNOWS** them.

SECOND-ORDER CLAIM. Very many other human beings **know propositions of the same kind** about themselves — which is what makes 'COMMON sense' the right name.

WHY A LIST, NOT AN ARGUMENT. Arguing *for* the truisms from something more basic would concede that they need outside support. The size of the list displays the scale of the sceptic's task.

NOT **Not** the claim that whatever most people believe is true · **not** an appeal to convention · **not** a claim of infallibility. The list is a philosophical proposal and is **contestable**.

ANSWER LINE Moore's list is not a survey of opinion but an **inventory of what a sceptical argument would have to overturn**.

06

MOORE — KNOWING AGAINST ANALYSING, AND THE PARADOX OF ANALYSIS

KNOWING THAT P IS TRUE
Certain: 'I have two hands'
Pre-philosophical and secure
Established by ordinary perceptual standing, not by a theory

≠

KNOWING THE ANALYSIS OF P
Doubtful: what *is* a material object? sense-data? a class of appearances? a substance?
Philosophical work proper — **may remain unfinished**
Moore was himself a lifelong analyst; the difficulty is conceded, not denied

THE FALLACY MOORE NAMES 'You cannot know you have hands because you cannot analyse *material object*' is a **CONFUSION OF LEVELS**. Imprecision in stating a proposition is not doubt about it.

PARADOX OF ANALYSIS — bounded orientation, not a printed limb

① If the analysis of 'X is a brother' is 'X is a male sibling', **either** it says the same thing and is trivially uninformative,
② **or** it says something different and is not an analysis of that concept at all.
③ **No settled Moorean solution.** Fregean sense and mode of presentation, and later accounts of concepts and synonymy, are proposed responses.
④ **Use only** to show why analysis is not verbal substitution — and therefore why Moore needed the level distinction.

HONEST COST The distinction protects knowledge only if propositional knowledge can be **secure while its constituents are unclear** — which a sceptic about the given, or anyone who ties understanding to analysis, will deny.

07

MOORE — COMPARATIVE CERTAINTY AND THE REVERSAL OF THE BURDEN

A VALID ARGUMENT IS A SET OF SCALES, NOT A ONE-WAY STREET

THE SCEPTIC'S SIDE
P1 I cannot rule out that I am dreaming.
P2 If I cannot rule that out, I do not know I have a body.
C So I do not know I have a body.
Abstract · technical · contested by competent philosophers

WEIGH

THE TRUISM'S SIDE
'I have a body.'
'The earth has existed for many years past.'
'There have existed many other human beings, with bodies.'
As certain as anything I have ever been

A valid argument transmits credibility backwards as well as forwards → **If the conclusion is less credible than the premisses are, the argument has refuted a premiss** → **THE PRINCIPLE: an argument overturns a truism only if every premiss is more certain than the truism denied** → **RESULT: THE BURDEN OF PROOF IS REVERSED**

THE LIMIT — WRITE IT The principle presupposes that certainty is **comparable** across ordinary and philosophical propositions, and Moore supplies **no neutral measure**. A sceptic who denies that Moore *knows* the truism has been **outweighed, not shown to be irrational**.

LABEL DECODED (2019) **'Common sense'** comes from the **method**; **'realism'** from the **content** of the list — body, earth before my birth, other human beings. **The realism is a result, not a premiss.**

08

MOORE 1939 — THE PROOF, THE GLOSS AND THE THREE CONDITIONS

TARGET **Kant's charge** that it is 'a scandal to philosophy' that no satisfactory proof of things outside us has been given. Moore answers it literally.

`1  here is one hand  →  2  and here is another  →  3  two things met with in space exist  →  4  an external world exists`

The gloss that makes the inference valid: 'external to our minds' is explained as **things met with in space** — things whose existence does not consist in being experienced. Narrate the gesture as **right hand first, then left**, or omit the detail.

CONDITION OF A RIGOROUS PROOF	WHAT IT EXCLUDES	DOES THE HANDS PROOF MEET IT?
1 Premiss DIFFERENT from the conclusion	circular arguments that smuggle the conclusion into the premiss	**Yes** — 'here is a hand' is not synonymous with 'an external world exists'
2 Premiss KNOWN, not merely believed	arguments from assumptions, however plausible	Moore insists he **knew** it — **the contested condition**
3 Conclusion FOLLOWS	non sequiturs and rhetorical gestures	**Yes**, given the gloss on 'external'

THE CONCESSION Moore **cannot prove the premiss** — that would require proving he is not dreaming, 'and that I cannot do'. A proof requires a **known** premiss, not a **proved** one, or nothing whatever is ever proved.

ANSWER LINE The demand to prove **every** premiss is a demand that **no proof of anything could ever meet**.

09

MOORE — THE QUESTION-BEGGING OBJECTION AND THREE REPLIES

THE OBJECTION — and it is serious Premiss 1 is **exactly what the sceptic put in doubt**. If dreaming or deception cannot be excluded, Moore does not *know* premiss 1, condition 2 fails, and the proof **begs the question**.

REPLY 1 — MOORE'S OWN
Comparative. He need not establish the premiss from neutral ground.
The relevant comparison is between the certainty of 'here is a hand' and the certainty of the sceptic's premisses — and the ordinary proposition wins.

REPLY 2 — DIALECTICAL
Developed by later defenders such as **Pryor**.
The proof is not addressed to a sceptic who has already suspended perceptual knowledge; it exhibits the **cost** of scepticism — the surrender of a piece of knowledge better established than any premiss used to attack it.

REPLY 3 — THE LATER DIAGNOSIS
On Certainty asks whether such propositions are ordinary knowledge-claims at all, or **framework / hinge certainties** on which doubting itself depends.
Owner note: this is later Wittgenstein, **TOPIC 08**. One clause, never an expansion.

VERDICT SPINE Formally **valid** · **no neutral criterion** of knowledge supplied · force is **comparative** — which is exactly what Moore claimed for it and nothing more. **1925 + 1939 = one strategy in two texts**: compare credentials rather than assume the philosophical claim wins.

10

MOORE 1903 — ESSE EST PERCIPI AND THE ACT/OBJECT DISTINCTION

TARGET **To be is to be perceived (*esse est percipi*).** For the idealist inference to work, the object's *being* must be nothing over and above its *being perceived* — so the sensation and its object must be **one thing**, or the object a mere constituent of the act.

ACT OF AWARENESS — THE COMMON ELEMENT
Consciousness; the **same** in every sensation
What the sensations of blue and of green **share**
Elusive, because attention passes **through** it

≠

OBJECT OF AWARENESS — THE VARIABLE ELEMENT
Blue, green, this sound; **different** in each sensation
What makes one sensation differ from another
What we find when we try to introspect the act

WHY THE ARGUMENT IS STRUCTURAL, NOT INTROSPECTIVE

① Two sensations must have something **in common** — both are sensations.
② Two sensations must **differ** in something — their objects differ.
③ On the identity thesis there is only **one item** in each, so nothing is available to play both roles.
④ ∴ Awareness and object are **distinct**, and the identification *esse est percipi* requires is unavailable.

ANSWER LINE **What varies cannot be what stays the same.**

11

MOORE — THE TWO PRINTED SENTENCES, DECODED

`“Blue is one object of sensation and green is another, and consciousness, which both sensations have in common, is different from either.”`

2025 Q3(c). Read the sentence as a **labelling of the argument**: 'blue … green' names the VARIABLE element (the objects); 'which both sensations have in common' names the COMMON element (consciousness); 'is different from either' is the CONCLUSION.

`“… to say ‘Blue exists’ is the same thing as to say ‘Both blue and consciousness exist’ … a mistake and a self-contradictory mistake.”`

2020 Q2(b). The examinable word is **self-contradictory**, and the four steps below are the decoding that earns the mark.

WHY SELF-CONTRADICTORY

① The claim is that the two statements say the **same thing**.
② The second statement is formed by **conjoining two distinct items**, blue and consciousness.
③ To assert the identity of content, the speaker must already **possess and use** the very distinction whose significance he denies.
④ ∴ The identification is not merely false; it **cannot be stated without presupposing its own falsity**.

THE RESIDUAL — the 'critically' half The charge bites hardest against a strict **identity** formulation. An idealist who says instead that blue is **dependent on** consciousness without being **identical** with it has not been convicted of contradiction — he has been **deprived of the argument he had**.

12

MOORE — TRANSPARENCY, AND THE EXACT BOUNDARY OF THE RESULT

TRANSPARENCY / DIAPHANOUSNESS Introspect the sensation of blue and what you find is **the blue**. The act is elusive, 'as if it were diaphanous'. This is a **diagnosis** of why the conflation is tempting — **not a premiss** of the refutation. Later philosophers of mind use the same observation **against** Moore; his reply must be that **elusiveness is not absence**.

ACHIEVED
The **identity route** from object to act is **blocked**
∴ *esse est percipi* is **not established**
The act/object distinction becomes foundational for analytic philosophy — Russell takes it over for sense-data

vs

NOT ACHIEVED
That any object exists **unperceived**
A positive **theory of perception** — the sense-data / material-object relation is left open
A refutation of **Absolute Idealism**, which rests on internal relations, not on the perceptual equation
A refutation of Berkeley's **whole** philosophy — his positive system is **TOPIC 03**

2018 Q3(a) COMPARATIVE HALF **Moore** is epistemic and distinction-drawing: he blocks the argument and leaves the analysis open. **Russell** is logical and reconstructive: he concedes that what is given is sense-data, rebuilds physical objects as **logical constructions**, removes apparent names by **contextual analysis**, and breaks with Berkeley's nominalism by admitting acquaintance with **universals**.

13

RUSSELL — INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS AND CONTEXTUAL DEFINITION

NO MEANING IN ISOLATION — the symbol means nothing on its own → **CONTEXTUAL DEFINITION — rules give the meaning of whole sentences containing it** → **DISAPPEARS ON ANALYSIS — no corresponding constituent survives** → **ONTOLOGICAL ECONOMY — commitment only to what satisfies the predicates**

Technique inherited from contextual definition in *Principia Mathematica* (1910–13).

THE TEST TO APPLY IN THE EXAM
Does the expression **survive analysis as a constituent** of the proposition?
'the author of *Waverley*' — **does not survive** → incomplete symbol
'Scott', as a genuine name — **would survive**

→

THE COMMONEST ERROR
'Incomplete' read as **'meaningless'**
The phrase is systematically **meaning-contributing**; it has no meaning **on its own**
Write the words **'in isolation'** and the error cannot occur

OPTIONAL BACKGROUND ONLY **Russell's paradox** and the **theory of types** supply the habit behind the doctrine — a symbol may be *eliminable* rather than referential, and a well-formed-looking string may fail to express a proposition. **Not a printed limb.** One sentence maximum.

14

RUSSELL 1905 — THE THEORY OF DESCRIPTIONS, IN NOTATION

THE PROBLEM
'The present King of France is bald.'
Grammatically impeccable · understood by every competent speaker · **and there is no present King of France**

THREE ANSWERS RUSSELL REJECTS
(a) meaningless — but we understand it and can argue about it
(b) about a subsisting object — **Meinong's** route; it populates the world with golden mountains, and the round square threatens non-contradiction
(c) denotes something else — no candidate survives inspection

$$\text{“The F is G”} = (\exists x)[Fx \wedge \forall y(Fy \rightarrow y = x) \wedge Gx]$$

EXISTENCE (at least one) · **UNIQUENESS** (at most one) · **PREDICATION** (it is G). **Uniqueness is the conjunct most often dropped** — without it the analysis renders 'the' as 'a' and the definite article's whole contribution disappears.

"The golden mountain is very high" → $(\exists x)[Gx \wedge \forall y(Gy \rightarrow y=x) \wedge Hx]$ → **The existence conjunct is FALSE** → **∴ the whole conjunction is FALSE — not meaningless, and no Meinongian object subsists**

The golden mountain is **Meinong's own stock example** — name him, and the answer shows what the theory was *for*.

PRINCIPLE ESTABLISHED **Grammatical form ≠ logical form.** The task of philosophy is to reveal the logical form hidden by language — the founding methodological claim of analytic philosophy.

15

RUSSELL — THE THREE PUZZLES, AND WHAT EACH WAS BLOCKING

PUZZLE	WHAT WENT WRONG BEFORE RUSSELL	WHAT THE ANALYSIS DELIVERS
NEGATIVE EXISTENTIALS 'The present King of France does not exist'	To deny that something exists you seem to have to **refer** to it first, which grants exactly the existence you are denying	The denial becomes the **negation of an existence-and-uniqueness claim**; no reference is attempted, so nothing is granted — and the sentence is **true**
EXCLUDED MIDDLE	If 'the F is G' is neither true nor false when there is no F, **bivalence appears to fail**	It is **false**; its negation, parsed with the **negation taking wide scope**, is **true**. The apparent failure is a **scope ambiguity**
SUBSTITUTIVITY IN ATTITUDE CONTEXTS George IV and the author of *Waverley*	If 'the author of *Waverley*' = Scott, George IV wished to know whether **Scott was Scott** — trivial	The description is **not a name** and denotes nothing in the required sense, so **no substitution licence exists**

THE ADVERTISEMENT **One device, three independent problems.** A theory that does this is not an *ad hoc* repair — say so explicitly; it is the 'why it matters' mark. **Not one of the three:** the problem of universals, which Russell handles by his realism about universals.

16

RUSSELL — SCOPE, AND THE STRAWSON OBJECTION

PRIMARY OCCURRENCE — description takes wide scope
'The King of France is not bald' =
there is exactly one King of France AND he is not bald
→ FALSE

SCOPE

SECONDARY OCCURRENCE — negation takes wide scope
'The King of France is not bald' =
it is not the case that (there is exactly one King of France and he is bald)
→ TRUE

STRAWSON 1950 — 'On Referring' Russell has confused a **sentence** with a **use** of a sentence. A speaker does not **assert** that there is exactly one King of France; he **presupposes** it. When the presupposition fails, **the question of truth or falsity does not arise** — the utterance is not false but void.

RUSSELL'S AVAILABLE REPLIES

① Strawson describes **conversational expectation**; Russell gives **truth-conditions**, and a logic requires them.
② Presupposition failure needs a semantics of its own — typically a **truth-value gap** — and gaps carry their own costs for classical logic.
③ The analysis is a proposal about **logical form** for a scientifically regimented language, not ordinary-language lexicography.

HONEST VERDICT A **genuine rival analysis**, not a demonstration of error: Strawson describes ordinary **use** better and Russell describes **logical form** better. **Owner boundary:** Strawson appears here as **one objection**; his positive theory of reference and his descriptive metaphysics are **TOPIC 11**.

17

RUSSELL — ACQUAINTANCE, DESCRIPTION AND THE PRINCIPLE

KNOWLEDGE BY ACQUAINTANCE
Direct, presentational, non-inferential — 'without the intermediary of any process of inference'
A relation to a **thing**, not the possession of a proposition
Objects: sense-data · memory data · introspective data of one's own mental states · **UNIVERSALS**
The Platonic concession: acquaintance with universals is a large admission for a philosopher in the empiricist line, made openly **against Berkeley's nominalism**

vs

KNOWLEDGE BY DESCRIPTION
Indirect, propositional — knowledge *that* exactly one thing is F, plus what is inferred of it
Objects: physical objects · other minds · historical persons · unobservables of science
Yields **denoting phrases** — 'the F' — contextually eliminated rather than treated as names
Built out of acquaintance-items by **logical construction**

`“Every proposition which we can understand must be composed wholly of constituents with which we are acquainted.”`

The Principle of Acquaintance, *The Problems of Philosophy* (1912), Ch. 5 — safe to quote verbatim. **It constrains UNDERSTANDING, not truth.**

THE ARGUMENT THAT MAKES DESCRIPTIONS NECESSARY

① To understand a proposition is to **grasp its constituents**.
② I can grasp only what I am **acquainted with**.
③ Yet I plainly understand propositions about **Bismarck, Julius Caesar and electrons**.
④ ∴ Either the Principle is false, **or** those items are not constituents of the propositions.
⑤ The **theory of descriptions** takes the second route: 'the F is G' contains no constituent *the F*; its constituents are the **universals** F and G plus logical apparatus.
⑥ ∴ The Principle is **preserved** — descriptions are the instrument that saves the epistemology.

THE BISMARCK SERIES — RUSSELL'S OWN GRADED EXAMPLE	ROUTE
Bismarck himself	acquaintance with his own self-consciousness — the constituent is given to him
A person who met Bismarck	acquaintance with sense-data he took to be of the man; the description is anchored to **his** particulars
A person who only read of Bismarck	knowledge purely by description — 'the first Chancellor of the German Empire'
All of us, of 'the most long-lived of men'	a description satisfied by someone we may never identify — yet the proposition is **fully understood**

ANSWER LINE The theory of descriptions is **the price Russell pays to keep the Principle of Acquaintance** while speaking of what he has never met.

18

RUSSELL — LOGICALLY PROPER NAMES, AND THE TWO MODERN OBJECTIONS

LOGICALLY PROPER NAME — directly designates an item of acquaintance and could not fail to designate → **Only the demonstratives 'this' and 'that', used of what is presently given** → **∴ ordinary names — 'Bismarck', 'Socrates', 'Homer' — are DISGUISED DESCRIPTIONS** → **∴ the class of genuine names shrinks almost to nothing, and differently for each speaker and moment**

KRIPKE — *Naming and Necessity*, lectures 1970, book 1980
Ordinary proper names are **not** disguised descriptions.
'Aristotle' would still name Aristotle even if every description we associate with him were false — names are **rigid designators**.
Russell's retreat: confine the claim to *logically* proper names and abandon the description theory of ordinary names.
Standard verdict: the **logic** of descriptions survives; the **theory of names** does not.

vs

SELLARS — 'Empiricism and the Philosophy of Mind', 1956
The Myth of the Given: nothing is given uninterpreted, and what is given non-conceptually cannot **justify** beliefs.
Russell's reply: acquaintance is **presentation**, not knowledge of truths.
Residual: then how does it **ground** anything? This is the live weakness of the whole edifice.

KEEP THEM APART Kripke attacks the theory of **names**; Sellars attacks the **base**. Different targets, different residues — and Russell can survive one without surviving the other. **Phase warning:** sense-data acquaintance, the 1918 atomism and later **neutral monism** are three positions at three times.

19

RUSSELL 1914 — LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS AND THE SUPREME MAXIM

`“Wherever possible, substitute constructions out of known entities for inferences to unknown entities.”`

Russell's **supreme maxim in scientific philosophising** — 'The Relation of Sense-Data to Physics' and *Our Knowledge of the External World*, both 1914. Ockham's razor converted into a working procedure.

ROUTE A — INFERENCE
Posit a table **behind** the appearances, causing them, never itself met
Cost: an entity I can never check, doing explanatory work I cannot inspect
Risk: unknowable posits multiply and scepticism gets a foothold

MAXIM

ROUTE B — CONSTRUCTION
Define 'the table' as an ordered system of **actual and possible** appearances from various viewpoints
Cost: the system must really be specifiable
Gain: no new entity; truth-conditions stated in terms already understood

APPARENT ENTITY	CONSTRUCTED OUT OF	TYPE
A physical object — 'this table'	classes of **actual and possible** sense-data from various points of view	perceptual
A 'nation'	patterns of behaviour of individual persons	social
A number	classes of equinumerous classes (Frege–Russell)	mathematical
A point of space	convergent classes of volumes	geometrical

THREE THINGS A CONSTRUCTION IS NOT **Not a fiction** — we say **true** things about tables and nations · **not** an elimination of ordinary talk — the talk is preserved and given truth-conditions · **not** a permanent phenomenalist metaphysics — the base later becomes **neutral events**.

THE STRAIN The construction needs **possible** sense-data from viewpoints no one occupies. These are not straightforwardly *known* entities, so the inference the maxim was meant to avoid may have been smuggled back; and a private base invites **solipsism**. **Verdict:** the technique is permanent, the 1914 inventory is a phase.

20

RUSSELL 1918 — LOGICAL ATOMISM, AND THE 2020 SENTENCE DECODED

`“The atoms that I wish to arrive at as the sort of last residue in analysis are logical atoms and not physical atoms.”`

2020 Q2(c). The 1918 lectures were delivered in London and published in *The Monist* 1918–19; **Russell's own preface credits the ideas to Wittgenstein**.

PHRASE	WHAT IT ESTABLISHES
'last residue in **analysis**'	Atomism is defined by a **method**: an atom is whatever survives when analysis has removed every complexity
'**logical** … not **physical**'	The atoms are constituents of **facts** — particulars, qualities, relations — not tiny bodies
'my **doctrine**'	An **ontology read off a logic**, not off a physics

WORLD = FACTS, NOT THINGS
A **fact** is what makes a proposition true or false
Facts are truth-makers, not truth-bearers — a fact is not true; a proposition is
A complete catalogue of objects still leaves undecided **which qualities they have and how they are related**

→

THE STRUCTURE OF AN ATOMIC FACT
Monadic: a particular exemplifies a quality — 'this is red'
Relational: particulars stand in a relation — 'this is to the left of that'
'Atomic' = contains no other FACTS. It plainly has constituents; reading it as 'partless' is as damaging as reading it as 'microscopic'

21

RUSSELL — TRUTH-FUNCTIONS, ISOMORPHISM AND NEGATIVE FACTS

UPPER STOREY — MOLECULAR PROPOSITIONS
'this is red **and** that is blue' · **'or'** · **'not'** · **'if–then'**
Truth-value fixed **entirely** by the atoms below plus the connective → **no additional fact answers to 'and' or 'or'**

▲

GROUND FLOOR — ATOMIC PROPOSITIONS
'this is red' · 'this is to the left of that' — no logical connectives

▲

FOUNDATION — ATOMIC FACTS
Isomorphism: the true proposition and the fact share logical structure — names ↔ objects, arrangement ↔ arrangement

RUSSELL ON TRUE NEGATIONS
'Socrates is not alive' is **true**. What makes it true?
Negative facts, reluctantly accepted — that a positive state does **not** obtain
Cost: absences are added to the inventory of the world
Why he pays it: to preserve a **direct truth-making relation**

vs

WITTGENSTEIN'S DIFFERENT ROUTE
Obtaining elementary states constitute the world, and their **totality** also determines which possible states do **not** obtain (2.05)
Negation is not a further object; **'the logical constants are not representatives'** (4.0312)
∴ no negative facts required

THE EXPOSED ASSUMPTION The programme requires that **every** proposition be a truth-function of atomic ones. **Belief-contexts** ('George IV believes that p') and **modal** contexts resist this. Concede the difficulty; do not pretend the reduction is complete.

22

RUSSELL — HOW FAR DESCRIPTIONS SUPPORT ATOMISM

WHAT DESCRIPTIONS DO SUPPLY
Contextual analysis removes **merely apparent constituents** — 'the F' is shown not to be a constituent at all
What remains is **quantified structure plus genuine logical constituents**
Exactly the discrimination atomism needs: **real residues separated from grammatical illusions**
Methodological continuity — both rest on grammatical form ≠ logical form

vs

WHAT DESCRIPTIONS DO NOT SUPPLY
No proof that analysis **terminates**
No identification of the **simples**
No demonstration that reality is **exhaustively** atomic
Removing one class of pseudo-constituents is **not** reaching a base

ACQUAINTANCE fixes what is directly available → **INCOMPLETE SYMBOLS supply the technique of elimination** → **LOGICAL CONSTRUCTIONS apply it to the entities of common sense and science** → **LOGICAL ATOMISM names the residue analysis expects to find**

The four-stage route that answers **2018 Q4(c)**, **2022 Q1(b)** and **2024 Q3(a)**.

THE VERDICT SENTENCE — WRITE IT The theory of descriptions makes logical atomism **reasonable** and does not make it **proved**: it shows how a residue is reached in a particular case, and leaves open whether every analysis reaches one. *Incomplete symbols are the scalpel, constructions are the operations, atomism is the anatomy the surgeon expects to find — and the anatomy was never completed.*

23

THE TRACTATUS — FACTS, OBJECTS AND STATES OF AFFAIRS

- **1** The world is all that is the case.
  - **1.1** The world is the **totality of FACTS, not of THINGS**.
    - **1.13** The facts in **logical space** are the world.
      - **2** What is the case, a fact, is the **existence of states of affairs**.
        - **2.01** A state of affairs is a **combination of objects**.
          - **2.013** Each thing is, as it were, in a space of possible states of affairs — **possibility is built into the object**.

WHY FACTS AND NOT THINGS
A complete inventory of objects leaves everything undecided.
It does not tell you which qualities they have or how they are related.
What is the case is a matter of **configuration** — and a configuration is a **fact**.

OBJECTS
Logical **simples**, characterised not by an intrinsic description but by the **states of affairs into which they can enter**.
The honest gap: the text gives **no uncontested example** of a simple object or an elementary proposition — it argues that simples are *required*, and does not exhibit them.

TRANSLATION CONTROL
Sachverhalt = **'atomic fact'** (Ogden/Ramsey) = **'state of affairs'** (Pears–McGuinness).
Choose one rendering and stay with it.
Do not identify Tractarian objects with Russell's epistemically identified atoms.

24

THE TRACTATUS — THE PICTURE THEORY, AND THE TWO FORMS

THE PICTURING RELATION — three requirements

① **Elements** of the picture (names) correspond to **objects**.
② The **arrangement** of the elements depicts an arrangement of the objects.
③ A **method of projection** connects sign to situation: the propositional **sign** plus its **projective relation** to the world is the **proposition** (3.11–3.12).

TRUE · FALSE · MEANINGFUL EITHER WAY True if the depicted state of affairs obtains, false if it does not — and **meaningful either way**, because a **possible** arrangement is presented. **2.223** 'to tell whether a picture is true or false we must compare it with reality'; **2.224** 'it is impossible to tell from the picture alone whether it is true or false'.

	PICTORIAL FORM (*Form der Abbildung*)	LOGICAL FORM (*logische Form*)
What is it?	What a picture must share with reality to depict it **at all, in its own medium**	The most abstract structural commonality — what **every** picture, in any medium, must share with reality (**2.18**)
Example	A spatial model shares **spatial** form; a musical score shares **acoustic** form	Every meaningful proposition shares **logical** form with the fact it depicts
Reach	A picture can depict only what shares **its** form	A proposition can depict **any** fact whatever — logical form is the universal medium
Status	A feature of a **kind** of picture	The form of **all possible representation**; every picture is a **logical** picture (**2.182**)
Depictable?	A spatial form can be represented in another medium	**No** — any depiction would already presuppose it

2022 Q3(c) — THE SECOND HALF **How logical form defines the language–world relation:** because logical form is **common** to proposition and fact, language and world are not two realms needing a bridge. The relation is **internal** — constitutive of the proposition's being a picture at all — not an external correlation fixed by convention or causal contact. **Provenance:** 'picture theory' is the commentators' label; Wittgenstein writes *Bild* and *abbilden*.

25

THE TRACTATUS — BIPOLARITY, LOGICAL SPACE AND THE GRUNDGEDANKE

BIPOLARITY — the condition of sense (stronger than bivalence)

① To depict is to represent something **as** being the case.
② To represent something as being the case is to allow that it **might not** be the case.
③ ∴ Sense requires the genuine availability of **both** truth-values. Anchors **4.06**, **2.223**, **2.224**; the term is from the *Notes on Logic* (1913).

LOGICAL SPACE — ANCHOR	WHAT IT ESTABLISHES
1.13 the facts in logical space are the world	Possibility is the medium in which facts are located
3.4 a proposition determines a **place** in logical space	To understand *p* is to know **which side of the field** you are being put on
3.41 · 3.42 the propositional sign and the logical co-ordinates	The logical place is guaranteed by the mere existence of the constituent parts
4.463 a proposition 'is like a solid body that restricts the freedom of movement of others'	**A proposition is a limit on how the world may be** — sense is exclusion
4.0312 **'the logical constants are not representatives'**	Wittgenstein's own **fundamental idea** (*Grundgedanke*): negation names nothing
5.6 the limits of my language mean the limits of my world	One cannot think outside logical space, so its bounds cannot be described from outside

ANSWER LINE **If the world could not refute it, it did not tell you anything.** To understand *p* is to understand ¬*p* — the same logical place, the opposite pole.

26

THE TRACTATUS — THE GENERAL FORM, THE N-OPERATOR AND THE TWO FAILURES

$$6: \quad [\bar{p}, \bar{\xi}, N(\bar{\xi})] \qquad 4.5: \quad \text{“This is how things stand”}$$

$\bar{p}$ the totality of **elementary propositions** · $\bar{\xi}$ any arbitrarily selected **set** of propositions already formed · **N(ξ̄)** the result of applying the **N-operator**. Ogden renders 4.5 'Such and such is the case' — flag the rendering.

N = JOINT NEGATION — none of the selected propositions is true → $\neg p = N(p)$ → $p \vee q = N(N(p,q))$ → $p \wedge q = N(N(p), N(q))$

Quantification is handled through sets of values of propositional functions (**5.52**); the adequacy of the notation for **infinite or multiply general** cases is disputed.

WHAT PROPOSITION 6 ASSERTS

① Every proposition is a **truth-function** of elementary propositions (**5**).
② Every truth-function is producible by repeated application of **one** operation, N.
③ ∴ There is **one** general form — that of a **formal series** generated from the elementary base.
④ ∴ **Logic needs no primitive propositions and no logical objects** — the decisive break with **Russell and Frege**.
⑤ ∴ 'There can be **no surprises in logic**' (**6.1251**), and logic's propositions are **tautologies** (**6.1**).
⑥ ∴ Whatever cannot be produced by this rule **is not a proposition** — the general form is the **criterion of the sayable**.

SENSELESS (*sinnlos*) — well formed, but empty
Tautology: true under every truth-condition; excludes **nothing** — 'it is raining or it is not raining'
Contradiction: false under every truth-condition; excludes **everything**
They belong to the symbolism and **show the scaffolding of logic** (4.461–4.4611, 6.124). **Not nonsensical.**

≠

NONSENSICAL (*unsinnig*) — no sense at all
'The Absolute is perfect' · 'There are objects'
Depicts **no possible situation**; it never entered logical space, so there is nothing for it to exclude
The most tested discrimination in the Tractatus — and the point at which scripts wrongly import verificationism

FOUR PRESSURES — state as pressures, not conceded refutations Simples and elementary propositions are **required but never exhibited** · elementary propositions are **logically independent** (2.061, 4.211) — **colour exclusion** pressures this, and drove 'Some Remarks on Logical Form' (1929), whose analysis Wittgenstein quickly abandoned · **all** propositions are truth-functions — belief-contexts (5.54–5.542) resist · the N-operator over **infinite** domains is disputed. **Colour exclusion does not license importing meaning-as-use, which is TOPIC 08.**

27

THE TRACTATUS — SAYING, SHOWING, THE LIMIT, THE LADDER AND 7

WHY THE DISTINCTION IS FORCED, NOT STIPULATED

① A proposition depicts by **sharing logical form** with what it depicts.
② To **depict** that sharing, a further picture would have to stand **outside** logical form and represent it as one fact among others.
③ But any picture whatever **already has** logical form — there is no representation from outside representation.
④ A **regress** also threatens: each attempted statement of form would need its own form stated.
⑤ ∴ Logical form is **not sayable**. It **shows itself** in every proposition that has it — **4.1212** *'what can be shown, cannot be said'*.

CAN BE SAID (*gesagt*)
Propositions of **natural science** — pictures of facts (**6.53**)
Contingent states of affairs

→

CAN ONLY BE SHOWN (*gezeigt*)
Logical form — the structure every proposition shares with reality
The existence of objects — presupposed by significant language
Logical truths — they show the scaffolding of the world (**6.124**)
Ethics, aesthetics, the meaning of life, the mystical — **6.41** the sense of the world lies outside the world · **6.42** there can be no propositions of ethics · **6.421** ethics is transcendental · **6.522** 'there is indeed the inexpressible; this shows itself; it is the mystical'
The relation of language to reality — that a proposition pictures a fact shows itself in the proposition

THE LIMIT IS DRAWN FROM INSIDE **Preface:** the limit 'can only be drawn **in language**, and what lies on the other side of the limit will simply be nonsense.' **5.6 · 5.61. Solipsism, bounded orientation only: 5.62** what the solipsist *means* is correct but cannot be *said* · **5.632–5.633** the subject is a **limit** of the world — the eye is not in the visual field · **5.64** strict solipsism **coincides with pure realism**. The private-language critique is **TOPIC 08**.

`6.54  “throw away the ladder”          7  Ogden: “Whereof one cannot speak, thereof one must be silent.”`

Pears–McGuinness render 7 'What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence' — **name the translation**. **There is no proposition 7.1**: 7 is deliberately uncommented and stands alone. **6.53** gives the method: say nothing except what can be said, and show the metaphysician that he has given no meaning to certain signs.

STANDARD / INEFFABILITY READING
Logical form, value and the mystical **manifest themselves** although they cannot be stated as facts
The elucidations bring the reader to a recognition that cannot be stated

≠

RESOLUTE / THERAPEUTIC READING (Diamond, Conant)
6.54 licenses no body of ineffable truths
The apparent doctrines are **elucidatory nonsense**, to be discarded entirely

VERDICT **Justified as a derived diagnosis** — one structural error generates the whole family of philosophical problems. **Not fully justified as a stateable doctrine**, because the boundary cannot be stated without transgressing itself. **4.112**: philosophy is an **activity**, not a body of doctrine. **The *Tractatus* contains no verification principle — TOPIC 07.**

28

COMPARISON, CRITICISM LEDGER, PYQ ROUTING AND THE ANSWER SPINE

AXIS	MOORE	RUSSELL	EARLY WITTGENSTEIN
Target	scepticism and idealist conflation	misleading grammar and ontological inflation	conditions and **limits** of propositional sense
Core tool	common sense + act/object distinction	logical analysis — the theory of descriptions	picture theory of propositions
Ontology	ordinary objects accepted; full perceptual theory **underdetermined**	particulars, qualities/relations, facts, phase-specific constructions	facts in logical space; simple objects **unspecified**
Self / subject	conscious **act** distinguished from its **object**	acquaintance framework varies across phases	solipsism and the metaphysical subject at the **limit** (bounded)
Legacy	analytic / common-sense method	formal analysis and ontological economy	influences positivism, then his **own** later criticism

THE TWO ATOMISMS	RUSSELL	WITTGENSTEIN
What are the atoms?	acquainted **particulars plus qualities/relations** in the 1918 programme — not physical particles	**objects** — logical simples whose nature is unspecified and whose **possibilities of combination** determine logical space
Epistemological ground	combines logical analysis with a **changing** acquaintance-based epistemology	primarily a **condition-of-sense** argument, not a sense-datum identification
Logical independence	acknowledged, somewhat **loosely**	**strictly** insisted upon — elementary propositions are logically independent
Negation	**negative facts** accepted as a truth-making cost	the **totality** of obtaining states settles what does not obtain (2.05); 4.0312

CRITICISM LEDGER — OBJECTION	REPLY	RESIDUAL (this is where the marks are)
Moore: 'here is one hand' begs the question	the dialectical burden shifts; abstruse premisses are less certain than perceptual knowledge	**no neutral measure** of comparative certainty is supplied
Russell: Strawson's presupposition (1950)	a theory of truth-conditions is what a logic requires; gaps carry their own costs	a **genuine rival analysis** — use better described by Strawson, logical form by Russell
Russell: negative facts inflate the ontology; the atoms are unstable	accepted as a truth-making cost; analysis is provisional	**no fixed final inventory** was ever established
Tractatus: self-application — the book's own elucidations fail its test	**6.54** acknowledges the ladder problem	successful therapy **or** unstable doctrine — the standard/resolute split remains open
Tractatus: no uncontested examples of simples	simples are **required** for determinate sense	transcendental necessity **does not identify** an actual base

PYQ ROUTING — 14 OWNED PARTS OF 112, JOINT-HIGHEST, ONE IN EVERY YEAR	PARTS
MOORE — 5 parts	2019 Q3(c) 15 · 2020 Q2(b) 15 · 2021 Q3(a) 20 · 2024 Q1(c) 10 · 2025 Q3(c) 15
RUSSELL — 6 parts	2018 Q4(c) 15 · 2020 Q2(c) 15 · 2022 Q1(b) 10 · 2023 Q4(b) 15 · 2024 Q3(a) 20 · 2025 Q1(d) 10
EARLY WITTGENSTEIN — 3 parts	2018 Q3(c) 15 · 2021 Q4(c) 15 · 2022 Q3(c) 15
SUPPORTING, OWNED ELSEWHERE	2018 Q3(a) 20 (Empiricism — Moore vs Russell on Berkeley) · 2023 Q4(c) 15 and 2025 Q3(a) 20 (Later Wittgenstein — the transition)

ANSWER SPINE **10 marks:** problem → analysis → result → point. **15 marks:** frame → doctrine → quote → key move → result → assess. **20 marks:** frame → incomplete symbols → constructions → atomism → assess → close. **Directives:** descriptions demand **notation** · quotations demand that you **locate the sentence** · saying/showing demands the **derivation** · Moore demands the **structure of the reversal** · 'how is X related to Y' demands **support, not entailment** · comparison demands an **axis**.

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION One method used for three incompatible purposes, each leaving something deliberately unfinished. **Moore** reverses the burden and leaves the **analysis** open; **Russell** secures economy and leaves the **inventory** open; **early Wittgenstein** fixes the conditions of sense and leaves **the status of his own book** open. Permanent achievements: the reversal of the sceptical burden · the quantificational analysis of definite descriptions · sense as determinate exclusion within a field of possibilities. Permanent costs: no neutral measure of certainty · no completed base · no consistent way of stating the boundary the *Tractatus* draws. **State an achievement and its matching cost in the same sentence.**

CORE SPINE COMPLETE — STAGES 01–28

E

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT — NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Everything above is the complete core spine. Nothing in this single subordinate stage is needed to answer any of the fourteen routed questions; use it for **one closing clause** at most.

OPTIONAL MODULE	THE ISSUE	SAFE USE / PROMOTION TRIGGER
A1 Descriptions after the textbook solution	Is the theory a quantificational trick or a deeper account of how apparent names disappear? Orthodox · denoting-complex resistance · neo-Russellian scope reading	One evaluative sentence after the King-of-France analysis. Promote if a question asks whether descriptions are names.
A2 Constructions or phenomenal reduction?	Genuine reduction to sense-data, or methodological housekeeping? Strong phenomenalist · epistemic-structural · logical-housekeeping readings; solipsism objection	Only where a question links constructions to atomism or external-world knowledge. Promote if a question asks whether Russell is a phenomenalist.
A3 What 'showing' finally means	Ineffable truths, or ladder-like nonsense? Standard · resolute (Diamond, Conant) · mixed readings; the self-destruction objection	One closing paragraph in a saying/showing answer. Promote if a question asks whether the *Tractatus* is self-refuting.
A4 Russell's paradox and the theory of types	Background technique only: a symbol may be **eliminable** rather than referential, and a well-formed string may fail to express a proposition	**Not a printed limb.** One sentence maximum; never substitute types for the analysis of descriptions.
A5 Solipsism and the metaphysical subject	5.62 · 5.632–5.633 · 5.64 — the most vivid illustration of the say/show boundary	Illustration only. The private-language critique is TOPIC 08.
A6 Moore's naturalistic fallacy	*Principia Ethica* (1903): goodness is simple, unanalysable and non-natural; the Open Question Argument	**Named here only to be excluded.** One clause of scope-setting; it belongs to ethics, not to this clause.